



# Cryptography

University of Insubria

# Cryptography

Cryptography is the practice and study of techniques for secure (secret) communication in the presence of third parties called opponents

It is possible to obtain

- Confidentiality
- Integrity
- Authentication
- Non-repudiation

# Cryptography

- Confidentiality:

# Cryptography

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- **Integrity:** if the message has been modified during transmission, it must be possible to detect this
- **Authentication:** the identity of the parties in a communication must be verifiable
- **Non-repudiation:** if a person sends a specific message, it must not be possible for him to deny having done so

# Definitions

- **Cipher:** algorithm for performing operations to obscure (encrypt) a plaintext (encryption), or to restore a previously encrypted message (decryption)
  - **symmetric:** cipher that uses the same key to encrypt and decrypt
  - **asymmetric:** cipher that uses two keys
- **Key:** secret used in the cipher to encrypt or decrypt messages

# Kerckhoffs/Shannon Principle

The security of a cryptographic system should not depend on keeping the cryptographic algorithm hidden but only on keeping the key hidden

# Challenge

Crypto 01 - Encoding 1

# Crypto 01 - Encoding 1

## ASCII TABLE

| Decimal | Hexadecimal | Binary | Octal | Char                   | Decimal | Hexadecimal | Binary  | Octal | Char | Decimal | Hexadecimal | Binary  | Octal | Char  |
|---------|-------------|--------|-------|------------------------|---------|-------------|---------|-------|------|---------|-------------|---------|-------|-------|
| 0       | 0           | 0      | 0     | [NULL]                 | 48      | 30          | 110000  | 60    | 0    | 96      | 60          | 1100000 | 140   |       |
| 1       | 1           | 1      | 1     | [START OF HEADING]     | 49      | 31          | 110001  | 61    | 1    | 97      | 61          | 1100001 | 141   | a     |
| 2       | 2           | 10     | 2     | [START OF TEXT]        | 50      | 32          | 110010  | 62    | 2    | 98      | 62          | 1100010 | 142   | b     |
| 3       | 3           | 11     | 3     | [END OF TEXT]          | 51      | 33          | 110011  | 63    | 3    | 99      | 63          | 1100011 | 143   | c     |
| 4       | 4           | 100    | 4     | [END OF TRANSMISSION]  | 52      | 34          | 110100  | 64    | 4    | 100     | 64          | 1100100 | 144   | d     |
| 5       | 5           | 101    | 5     | [ENQUIRY]              | 53      | 35          | 110101  | 65    | 5    | 101     | 65          | 1100101 | 145   | e     |
| 6       | 6           | 110    | 6     | [ACKNOWLEDGE]          | 54      | 36          | 110110  | 66    | 6    | 102     | 66          | 1100110 | 146   | f     |
| 7       | 7           | 111    | 7     | [BELL]                 | 55      | 37          | 110111  | 67    | 7    | 103     | 67          | 1100111 | 147   | g     |
| 8       | 8           | 1000   | 10    | [BACKSPACE]            | 56      | 38          | 111000  | 70    | 8    | 104     | 68          | 1101000 | 150   | h     |
| 9       | 9           | 1001   | 11    | [HORIZONTAL TAB]       | 57      | 39          | 111001  | 71    | 9    | 105     | 69          | 1101001 | 151   | i     |
| 10      | A           | 1010   | 12    | [LINE FEED]            | 58      | 3A          | 111010  | 72    | :    | 106     | 6A          | 1101010 | 152   | j     |
| 11      | B           | 1011   | 13    | [VERTICAL TAB]         | 59      | 3B          | 111011  | 73    | ;    | 107     | 6B          | 1101011 | 153   | k     |
| 12      | C           | 1100   | 14    | [FORM FEED]            | 60      | 3C          | 111100  | 74    | <    | 108     | 6C          | 1101100 | 154   | l     |
| 13      | D           | 1101   | 15    | [CARRIAGE RETURN]      | 61      | 3D          | 111101  | 75    | =    | 109     | 6D          | 1101101 | 155   | m     |
| 14      | E           | 1110   | 16    | [SHIFT OUT]            | 62      | 3E          | 111110  | 76    | >    | 110     | 6E          | 1101110 | 156   | n     |
| 15      | F           | 1111   | 17    | [SHIFT IN]             | 63      | 3F          | 111111  | 77    | ?    | 111     | 6F          | 1101111 | 157   | o     |
| 16      | 10          | 10000  | 20    | [DATA LINK ESCAPE]     | 64      | 40          | 1000000 | 100   | @    | 112     | 70          | 1110000 | 160   | p     |
| 17      | 11          | 10001  | 21    | [DEVICE CONTROL 1]     | 65      | 41          | 1000001 | 101   | A    | 113     | 71          | 1110001 | 161   | q     |
| 18      | 12          | 10010  | 22    | [DEVICE CONTROL 2]     | 66      | 42          | 1000010 | 102   | B    | 114     | 72          | 1110010 | 162   | r     |
| 19      | 13          | 10011  | 23    | [DEVICE CONTROL 3]     | 67      | 43          | 1000011 | 103   | C    | 115     | 73          | 1110011 | 163   | s     |
| 20      | 14          | 10100  | 24    | [DEVICE CONTROL 4]     | 68      | 44          | 1000100 | 104   | D    | 116     | 74          | 1110100 | 164   | t     |
| 21      | 15          | 10101  | 25    | [NEGATIVE ACKNOWLEDGE] | 69      | 45          | 1000101 | 105   | E    | 117     | 75          | 1110101 | 165   | u     |
| 22      | 16          | 10110  | 26    | [SYNCHRONOUS IDLE]     | 70      | 46          | 1000110 | 106   | F    | 118     | 76          | 1110110 | 166   | v     |
| 23      | 17          | 10111  | 27    | [END OF TRANS. BLOCK]  | 71      | 47          | 1000111 | 107   | G    | 119     | 77          | 1110111 | 167   | w     |
| 24      | 18          | 11000  | 30    | [CANCEL]               | 72      | 48          | 1001000 | 110   | H    | 120     | 78          | 1111000 | 170   | x     |
| 25      | 19          | 11001  | 31    | [END OF MEDIUM]        | 73      | 49          | 1001001 | 111   | I    | 121     | 79          | 1111001 | 171   | y     |
| 26      | 1A          | 11010  | 32    | [SUBSTITUTE]           | 74      | 4A          | 1001010 | 112   | J    | 122     | 7A          | 1111010 | 172   | z     |
| 27      | 1B          | 11011  | 33    | [ESCAPE]               | 75      | 4B          | 1001011 | 113   | K    | 123     | 7B          | 1111011 | 173   | {     |
| 28      | 1C          | 11100  | 34    | [FILE SEPARATOR]       | 76      | 4C          | 1001100 | 114   | L    | 124     | 7C          | 1111100 | 174   |       |
| 29      | 1D          | 11101  | 35    | [GROUP SEPARATOR]      | 77      | 4D          | 1001101 | 115   | M    | 125     | 7D          | 1111101 | 175   | }     |
| 30      | 1E          | 11110  | 36    | [RECORD SEPARATOR]     | 78      | 4E          | 1001110 | 116   | N    | 126     | 7E          | 1111110 | 176   | ~     |
| 31      | 1F          | 11111  | 37    | [UNIT SEPARATOR]       | 79      | 4F          | 1001111 | 117   | O    | 127     | 7F          | 1111111 | 177   | [DEL] |
| 32      | 20          | 100000 | 40    | [SPACE]                | 80      | 50          | 1010000 | 120   | P    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 33      | 21          | 100001 | 41    | !                      | 81      | 51          | 1010001 | 121   | Q    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 34      | 22          | 100010 | 42    | "                      | 82      | 52          | 1010010 | 122   | R    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 35      | 23          | 100011 | 43    | #                      | 83      | 53          | 1010011 | 123   | S    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 36      | 24          | 100100 | 44    | \$                     | 84      | 54          | 1010100 | 124   | T    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 37      | 25          | 100101 | 45    | %                      | 85      | 55          | 1010101 | 125   | U    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 38      | 26          | 100110 | 46    | &                      | 86      | 56          | 1010110 | 126   | V    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 39      | 27          | 100111 | 47    | '                      | 87      | 57          | 1010111 | 127   | W    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 40      | 28          | 101000 | 50    | (                      | 88      | 58          | 1011000 | 130   | X    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 41      | 29          | 101001 | 51    | )                      | 89      | 59          | 1011001 | 131   | Y    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 42      | 2A          | 101010 | 52    | *                      | 90      | 5A          | 1011010 | 132   | Z    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 43      | 2B          | 101011 | 53    | +                      | 91      | 5B          | 1011011 | 133   | [    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 44      | 2C          | 101100 | 54    | ,                      | 92      | 5C          | 1011100 | 134   | \    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 45      | 2D          | 101101 | 55    | -                      | 93      | 5D          | 1011101 | 135   | ]    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 46      | 2E          | 101110 | 56    | .                      | 94      | 5E          | 1011110 | 136   | ^    |         |             |         |       |       |
| 47      | 2F          | 101111 | 57    | /                      | 95      | 5F          | 1011111 | 137   | _    |         |             |         |       |       |

# Crypto 01 - Encoding 1

```
2_crypto > python3 crypto01.py > ...  
1  vec = [102, 108, 97, 103, 123, 117, 103, 104, 95, 78, 117, 109, 66, 51, 114, 53, 95, 52, 49, 114, 51, 52, 100, 121, 125]  
2  for el in vec:  
3      value = chr(el)  
4      print(value, end="")  
5
```

flag: flag{ugh\_NumB3r5\_41r34dy}

# Challenge

Crypto 02 - Encoding 2



# Crypto 02 - Encoding 2

```
2_crypto > python3 crypto02.py > ...  
1  string = "666c61677b68337834646563696d616c5f63346e5f62335f41424144424142457d"  
2  
3  b = bytes.fromhex(string)  
4  print(b)  
5
```

flag: flag{h3x4decimal\_c4n\_b3\_ABADBABE}

# Challenge

Crypto 03 - Encoding 3

## Crypto 03 - Encoding 3

```
2_crypto > python3 crypto03.py > ...
1  from base64 import b64decode
2
3  s1 = "ZmxhZ3t3NDF0XzF0c19hbGxfYjE="
4  s2 = 664813035583918006462745898431981286737635929725
5
6  s1 = b64decode(s1)
7  s2 = s2.to_bytes(20, 'big')
8
9  print(s1 + s2)
10
```

flag: flag{w41t\_1ts\_all\_b1ts?\_4lw4ys\_H4s\_b33n}

# Symmetric encryption

$\mathcal{K}$ : key space

$\mathcal{M}$ : plaintext space

$\mathcal{C}$ : ciphertext space

Encryption scheme

- $\text{Gen} \rightarrow \mathcal{K}$
- $\text{Enc} : \mathcal{M} \times \mathcal{K} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$
- $\text{Dec} : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{K} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$

# Symmetric encryption

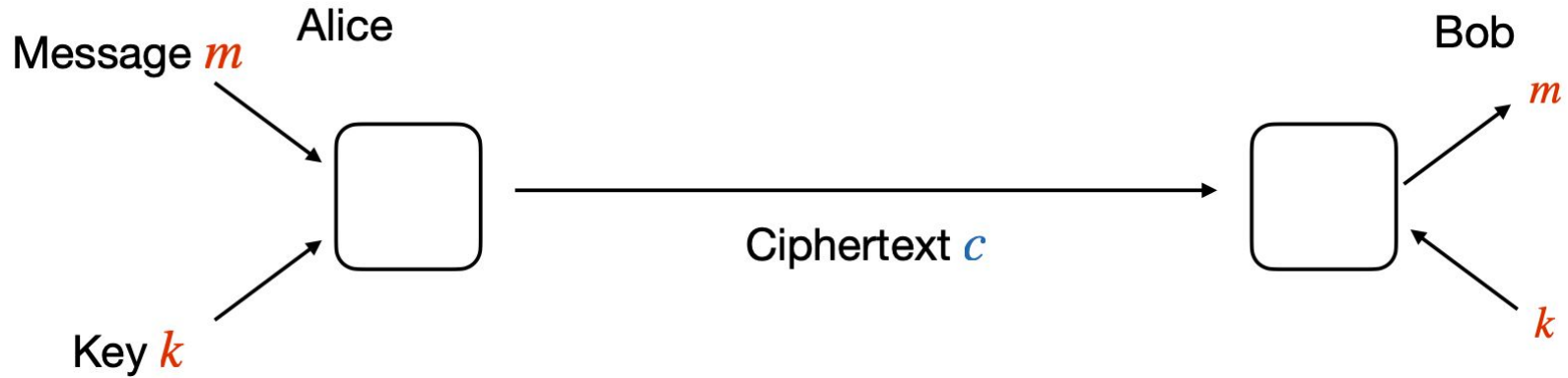
It is also known as private key or single key encryption. The secret key is known only to the sender and the recipient.

## Correctness

- $\text{encrypted\_message} = \text{Enc}(\text{message}, \text{key})$
- $\text{message} = \text{Dec}(\text{encrypted\_message}, \text{key})$

For every  $k \in \mathcal{K}$ , for every  $m \in \mathcal{M}$   $\text{Dec}_k(\text{Enc}_k(m)) = m$

# Symmetric encryption



# Sizes of key spaces

$2^{48}$  (Mifare Crypto-1): your smartphone

$2^{56}$  (DES): modern laptop

$2^{90}$  (hashes/year of Bitcoin network): large data center

$2^{128}$  (AES): reasonably secure

$2^{256}$  (AES): quantum-secure

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$2^{128}$  (AES): reasonably secure <- most used

$2^{256}$  (AES): quantum-secure



# Sizes of key spaces

Why 128?

- Estimated Sun lifetime:  $2^{60}$  secs = 10 billion years
- Suppose  $2^{50} \approx 10^{15}$  keys are tested per sec
- To find the right 128-bit key requires 128,000 (= 217) sun lifetimes

# Symmetric encryption

Cryptographic schemes differ in

- The type of operation in which a plaintext  $P$  is transformed into a ciphertext  $C$ 
  - **Substitutions:** each element of  $P$  is replaced with another element
  - **Transpositions:** exchanges are made between elements of  $P$
- Mode of “treatment” of  $P$ 
  - **Block ciphers:**  $P$  is processed by the algorithm “one block at a time”
  - **Stream ciphers:**  $P$  is processed considering a single element at a time

# Monoalphabetic Cipher

- An encryption technique based on substitution relies on replacing each element of the plaintext with another element from the same alphabet using a correspondence table. The correspondence table is the key.

## Example

- $\text{Enc}(\text{abc}, 5) = \text{fqt}$
- $\text{Dec}(\text{fqt}, 5) = \text{abc}$

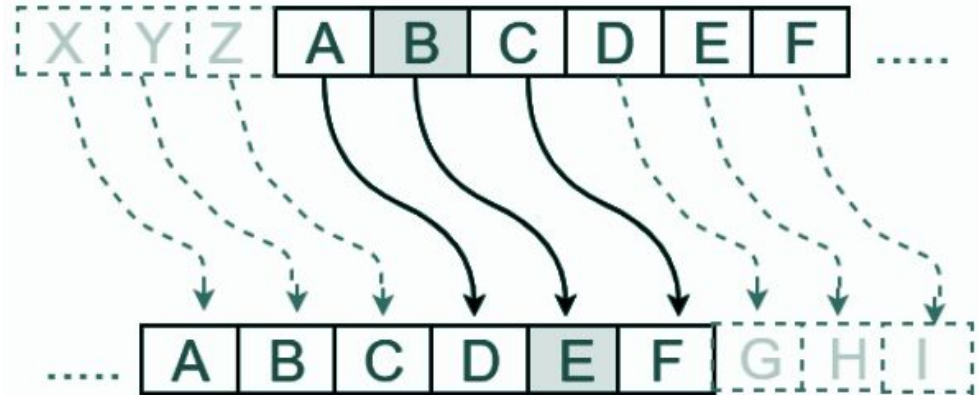
| Chiaro | Cifrato |
|--------|---------|
| a      | f       |
| b      | q       |
| c      | t       |
| d      | r       |
| ...    | ...     |
| z      | g       |

# Monoalphabetic Cipher

- Julius Caesar: the algorithm requires replacing each letter of the alphabet with the one which is "three hops" away; when the alphabet ends it starts counting again.

Example

- Enc(HELLO) =

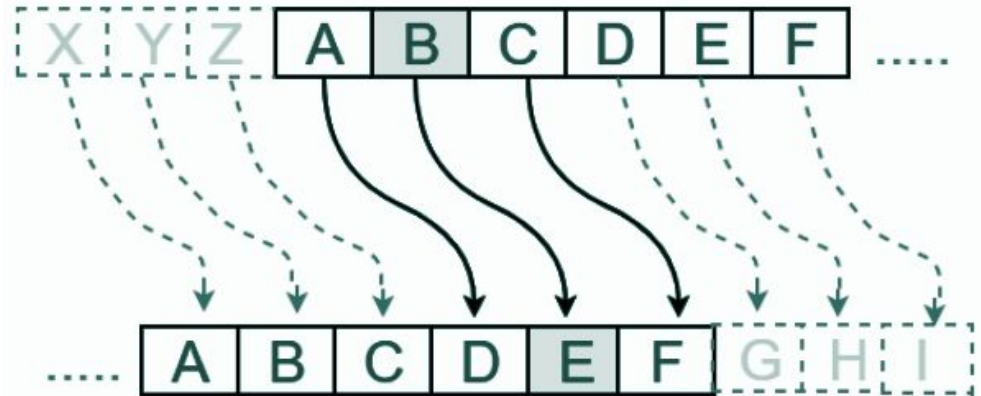


# Monoalphabetic Cipher

- Julius Caesar: the algorithm requires replacing each letter of the alphabet with the one which is "three hops" away; when the alphabet ends it starts counting again.

Example

- Enc(HELLO) = KHOOR
- Dec(KHOOR) =

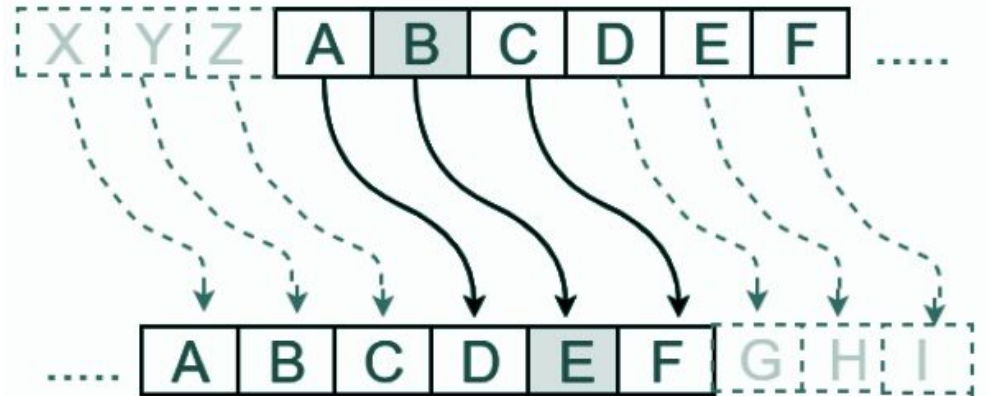


# Monoalphabetic Cipher

- Julius Caesar: the algorithm requires replacing each letter of the alphabet with the one which is "three hops" away; when the alphabet ends it starts counting again.

## Example

- Enc(HELLO) = KHOOR
- Dec(KHOOR) = HELLO



# Cryptanalysis

Cryptanalysis is the study and practice of analyzing and breaking cryptographic security systems to gain access to encrypted information without authorization.

- finding weaknesses in encryption algorithms
- cracking codes and recovering plaintext

## Attack types

- 
-

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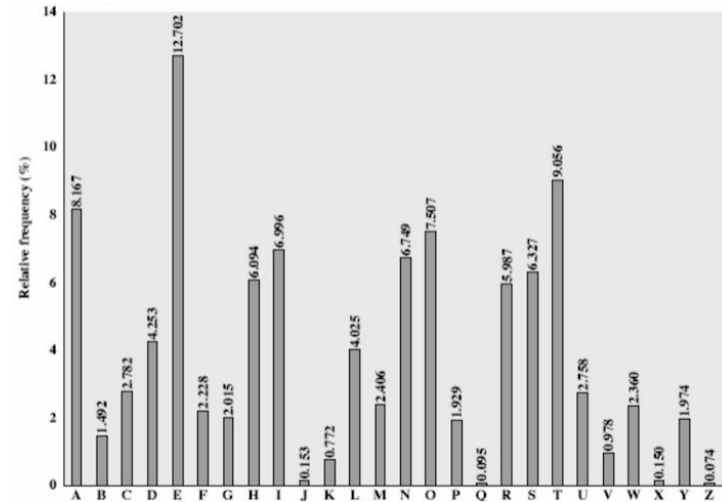
## Attack types

- **Analysis:** study of the algorithm
- **Brute-force:** try all possible keys

# Monoalphabetic Cipher

Substitution ciphers are vulnerable to frequency analysis attacks.

- In Italian the most frequent character is the character “e”. The second most frequent character is the character “a”
- With high probability, in the ciphertext the most frequent character will correspond to the character “e” and the second most frequent character will correspond to the character “a”



# Monoalphabetic Cipher

| ENGLISH |       | GERMAN |       | FINNISH |       | FRENCH |       | ITALIAN |       | SPANISH |       |
|---------|-------|--------|-------|---------|-------|--------|-------|---------|-------|---------|-------|
|         | %     |        | %     |         | %     |        | %     |         | %     |         | %     |
| E       | 12.31 | E      | 18.46 | A       | 12.06 | E      | 15.87 | E       | 11.79 | E       | 13.15 |
| T       | 9.59  | N      | 11.42 | I       | 10.59 | A      | 9.42  | A       | 11.74 | A       | 12.69 |
| A       | 8.05  | I      | 8.02  | T       | 9.76  | I      | 8.41  | I       | 11.28 | O       | 9.49  |
| O       | 7.94  | R      | 7.14  | N       | 8.64  | S      | 7.90  | O       | 9.83  | S       | 7.60  |
| N       | 7.19  | S      | 7.04  | E       | 8.11  | T      | 7.26  | N       | 6.88  | N       | 6.95  |
| I       | 7.18  | A      | 5.38  | S       | 7.83  | N      | 7.15  | L       | 6.51  | R       | 6.25  |

# Code

Julius Caesar

# Code - Julius Caesar

```
2  def inrange(n, range_min, range_max):
3      range_len = range_max - range_min + 1
4      a = n % range_len
5      if a < range_min:
6          a = a + range_len
7      return a
8
9  def caesar_shift(c, shift):
10     ascii = ord(c)
11     a = ascii + shift # Now we have a number between 32+shift and 126+shift
12     a = inrange(a, 32, 126) # Put the number back in range
13     return chr(a)
14
15  def caesar_cipher(plaintext, shift):
16     ciphertext = ''
17     for c in plaintext: # Iterate through the characters of a string
18         ciphertext = ciphertext + caesar_shift(c, shift)
19     return ciphertext
20
```

# Code - Julius Caesar

```
22 m = 'Hello! Can you read this?'
23 c = caesar_cipher(m, 6)
24 print('Ciphertext: ', c) # Ciphertext: Nkrru'Igt& u{xkgj&znoyE
25
26 m_2 = caesar_cipher(c, -6)
27 print('Plaintext: ', m_2) # Hello! Can you read this?
28
```

# Code

Julius Caesar - Brute Force

# Code - Julius Caesar - Brute Force

```

30
31 for i in range(26):
32     print('#', i, ': ', caesar_cipher(c, -i))
33

```

```

# 0 : Nkrriu'&Igt& u{&xkgj&znoyE
# 1 : Mjqqt&%Hfs%~tz%wjfi%ymnxD
# 2 : Lipps%$Ger$}sy$vieh$xlmwC
# 3 : Khoor$#Fdq#|rx#uhdg#wklvB
# 4 : Jgnnq#"Ecp"{qw"tgcf"vjkuA
# 5 : Ifmmp"!Dbo!zpv!sfbe!uijt@
# 6 : Hello! Can you read this?
# 7 : Gdkkn ~B`m~xnt~qd`c~sghr>
# 8 : Fcjjm~}A_l}wms}pc_b}rfgq=
# 9 : Ebiil}|@^k|v1r|ob^a|qefp<
# 10 : Dahhk|{?}j{ukq{na}`{pdeo;
# 11 : C`ggj{z>\iztjpm`\_zocdn:
# 12 : B_ffizy=[hysioyl[_^ynbcm9
# 13 : A^eehyx<Zgxrhnxk^Z]xmabl8
# 14 : @]ddgxw;Yfwqgmwj]Y\wl`ak7
# 15 : ?\ccfwv:Xevpflvi\X[vk_`j6
# 16 : >[bbevu9Wduoekuh[WZuj^_i5
# 17 : =Zaadut8VctndjtgZVYti]^h4
# 18 : <Y`cts7UbsmcisfYUXsh\]g3
# 19 : ;X__bsr6TarlbhreXTWrg[\f2
# 20 : :W^^arq5S`qkagqdWSVqfZ[e1
# 21 : 9V]]`qp4R_pj`fpcVRUpeYZd0
# 22 : 8U\\_po3Q^oi_eobUQTodXYc/
# 23 : 7T[[^on2P]nh^dnaTPSncwXb.
# 24 : 6SZZ]nm10\mg]cm`SORMbVWa-
# 25 : 5RYY\m10N[1f\b1_RNQ1aUV`

```



# Challenge

Tutte le strade portano a Roma

Source: <https://training.olicyber.it/>

Tutte le strade portano a Roma



1307 479

crypto

@ CryptedData98

Su un'antica pergamena è stata trovata questa citazione.  
Prova a decriptarla:

`cixd{xsb_zxbpxo_jlofqrof_qb_pxirqxkq}`

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

input: cixd{xs\_b\_zxbpxo\_jlofqrof\_qb\_pxirqxkq}

Cosa sappiamo?

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

input: cixd{xs\_b\_zxbpxo\_jlofqrof\_qb\_pxirqxkq}

Cosa sappiamo?

- la flag inizia con flag{...}

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

input: cixd{xs\_b\_zxbpxo\_jlofqrof\_qb\_pxirqxkq}

Cosa sappiamo?

- la flag inizia con flag{...}
- flag {--- \_ - - - - \_ - - - - - \_ - - - - - }

|   |   |   |  |
|---|---|---|--|
| a | x | n |  |
| b |   | o |  |
| c |   | p |  |
| d |   | q |  |
| e |   | r |  |
| f | c | s |  |
| g | d | t |  |
| h |   | u |  |
| i |   | v |  |
| j |   | w |  |
| k |   | x |  |
| l | i | y |  |
| m |   | z |  |

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

input: cixd{xs\_b\_zxbpxo\_jlofqrof\_qb\_pxirqxkq}

Cosa sappiamo?

- la flag inizia con flag{...}
- flag {a- - \_ -a - - a - \_ - - - - - \_ - - \_ - a l - - a - - }

|   |   |   |  |
|---|---|---|--|
| a | x | n |  |
| b |   | o |  |
| c |   | p |  |
| d |   | q |  |
| e |   | r |  |
| f | c | s |  |
| g | d | t |  |
| h |   | u |  |
| i |   | v |  |
| j |   | w |  |
| k |   | x |  |
| l | i | y |  |
| m |   | z |  |

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

```
2_crypto > tutte_le_strade_portano_a_roma.py > ...
1 s = "cixd{xs_b_zxbpxo_jlofgrof_qb_pxirq_xkq}"
2
3 for value in s:
4     ascii = ord(value)
5     if ascii == 95 or ascii == 123 or ascii == 125:
6         print(chr(ascii), end="")
7         continue
8
9     ascii = ascii + 3
10
11     if ascii > 122:
12         res = ascii % 122
13         ascii = 97 + res - 1
14
15     print(chr(ascii), end="")
16
```

```
2_crypto > tutte_le_strade_portano_a_roma.py > ...
1 s = "cixd{xs_b_zxbpxo_jlofgrof_qb_pxirq_xkq}"
2
3 for shift in range(26):
4     for value in s:
5         ascii = ord(value)
6         if ascii == 95 or ascii == 123 or ascii == 125:
7             print(chr(ascii), end="")
8             continue
9
10        ascii = ascii + shift
11
12        if ascii > 122:
13            res = ascii % 122
14            ascii = 97 + res - 1
15
16        print(chr(ascii), end="")
17    print("")
18
```

# Tutte le strade portano a Roma

VIEW

Ciphertext ▾

cixd{xs\_b\_zxbpxo\_jlofqrof\_qb\_pxirqxkq}

VIEW

Plaintext ▾

flag{ave\_caesar\_morituri\_te\_salutant}

ENCODE DECODE

Caesar cipher ▾

SHIFT

— 23 a→x +

ALPHABET

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CASE STRATEGY FOREIGN CHARS

Maintain case ▾ Include Ignore

← Decoded 37 chars

# Limitations of Monoalphabetic Cipher

Substitution ciphers have two limitations

- the possible number of shifts is limited
- it is easy to understand if a key is the correct one



# Polyalphabetic Cipher

Substitution ciphers are easy to break because they preserve the frequencies of the original alphabet

- Key idea: combine several substitution ciphers

The text is divided into blocks of fixed length and for each block a different substitution is applied for each character

- the key must be as long as the plaintext

# Vigenère Cipher

Message: chebellagioranta

Key: crypto

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| c | h | e | b | e | l | l | a | g | i | o | r | n | a | t | a |
| c | r | y | p | t | o | c | r | y | p | t | o | c | r | y | p |
| e | y | c | q | x | z | n | r | e | x | h | f | p | r | r | p |

Problem: Repeating the same substitution  
(alphabet) due to the periodic nature of the key

|   | a | b | c | d | e | f | g | h | i | j | k | l | m | n | o | p | q | r | s | t | u | v | w | x | y | z |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z |
| b | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A |
| c | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B |
| d | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C |
| e | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D |
| f | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E |
| g | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F |
| h | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G |
| i | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H |
| j | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I |
| k | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J |
| l | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K |
| m | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L |
| n | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M |
| o | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N |
| p | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O |
| q | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P |
| r | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q |
| s | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R |
| t | T | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S |
| u | U | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T |
| v | V | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U |
| w | W | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V |
| x | X | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W |
| y | Y | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X |
| z | Z | A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I | J | K | L | M | N | O | P | Q | R | S | T | U | V | W | X | Y |

# Secure Encryption

When can we say that a cipher is “secure”?

- a cipher is secure if the ciphertext “appears random,” that is, the ciphertext does not leak any information about the plaintext

Given  $c, c'$  should be difficult to decide if  $m \neq m'$

# Threat Models

- **Ciphertext-only attack:** adversary only get one or more cipher texts. Assumed so far.
- **Known-plaintext attack:** adversary gets plaintext/ciphertexts pairs. Must deduce information about other ciphertext
- **Chosen-plaintext attack:** adversary gets plaintext/ciphertext pairs for plaintext of her choice
- **Chosen-ciphertext attack:** adversary additionally may ask for decryptions of cipher texts of her choice

# XOR - Exclusive OR

The exclusive OR (XOR) is a binary operator that works on bits ( $\oplus$  is the symbol)

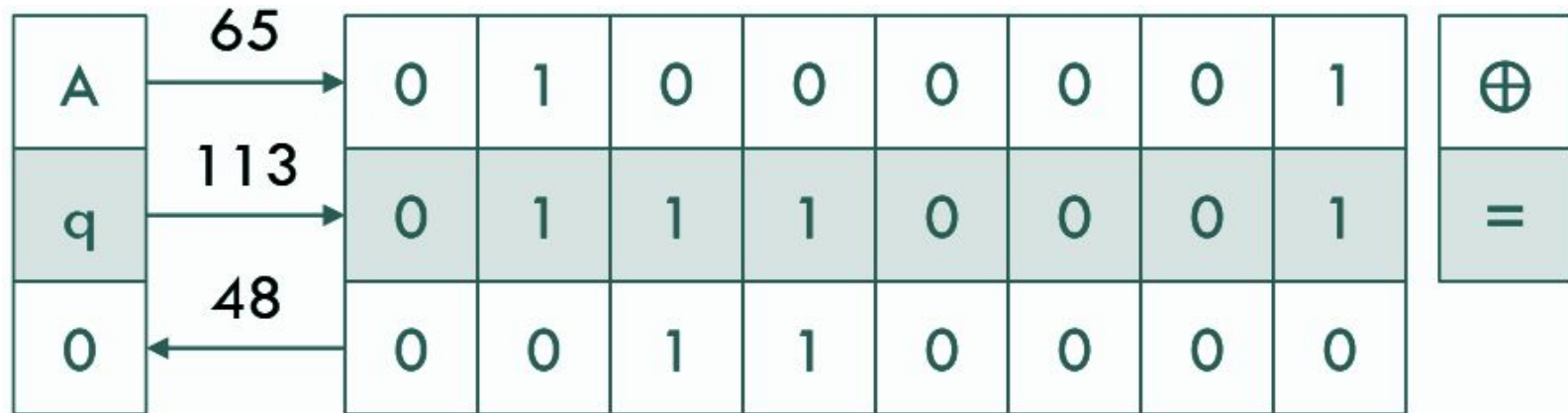
## Properties

- $a \oplus (b \oplus c) = (a \oplus b) \oplus c$
- $a \oplus b = b \oplus a$
- $a \oplus a = 0$
- $a \oplus 0 = a$
- $a \oplus b \oplus a = b$

| $a$ | $b$ | $a \oplus b$ |
|-----|-----|--------------|
| 0   | 0   | 0            |
| 0   | 1   | 1            |
| 1   | 0   | 1            |
| 1   | 1   | 0            |

# XOR - Exclusive OR

Convert the characters from ASCII to binary, calculate the XOR operation vertically and convert the result back



# XOR - Exclusive OR

XOR can be used as an encryption algorithm

- $m = m_1 m_2 m_3$
- $k = k_1 k_2 k_3$
- $c = (m_1 \oplus k_1) (m_2 \oplus k_2) (m_3 \oplus k_3)$

XOR encryption is vulnerable to known-plaintext attacks

- given  $m, c$  we can retrieve the key as  $k = m \oplus c$

# Challenge

Crypto 04 - Xor 1



# Crypto 04 - Xor 1

```
2_crypto > python3 crypto04.py > ...
1  def xor(a, b):
2      return bytes([x^y for x,y in zip(a,b)])
3
4  m1 = "158bbd7ca876c60530ee0e0bb2de20ef8af95bc60bdf"
5  m2 = "73e7dc1bd30ef6576f883e79edaa48dcd58e6aa82aa2"
6
7  m1 = bytes.fromhex(m1)
8  m2 = bytes.fromhex(m2)
9
10 res = xor(m1, m2)
11 print(res)
12
```

flag: flag{xOR\_f0r\_th3\_w1n!}

# Challenge

Crypto 05 - Xor 2

## Crypto 05 - Xor 2

```
2_crypto > python3 crypto05.py > ...
1  def xor(a, b):
2      return bytes([x ^ y for x, y in zip(a, b)])
3
4  ciphertext = "104e137f425954137f74107f525511457f5468134d7f146c4c"
5  ciphertext = bytes.fromhex(ciphertext)
6
7  for i in range(128):
8      k = chr(i)
9      k = str.encode(k) * len(ciphertext)
10     plaintext = xor(ciphertext, k)
11     print("flag{" + str(plaintext) + "}")
12
```

flag: flag{0n3\_byt3\_T0\_ru1e\_tH3m\_4LI}

# OTP - One Time Pad

The one-time pad encryption scheme is perfectly secret

- each bit of the result can be 0 or 1 with equal probability

## Operations

- $k \leftarrow \text{Gen}$  # sampled from a uniform distribution
- $\text{Enc}_k(m) = k \oplus m$
- $\text{Dec}_k(c) = k \oplus c$

Correctness:  $\text{Dec}_k(\text{Enc}_k(m)) = k \oplus k \oplus m = m$

# OTP - One Time Pad

## Downsides

- The secret key is as long as the message
- The secret key cannot be reused

$$\text{Enc}_k(m) \oplus \text{Enc}_k(m') = m \oplus k \oplus m' \oplus k = m \oplus m'$$

# Challenge

Crypto 06 - One more Time Please

# Crypto 06 - One more Time Please

```
Decryptions
1 | L CR TTOS ST MA CHE STO U I Z S D S U TI ILE
2 | ON L GGER I AI QUE TA SE R I F
3 | A MI PRE IO A FLAG flag_M_y P g_m_r
4 | MIE AMI I ONTINU NO A I I O R T I ZA E P U I N VAB L T
5 | ONO ICUR C E NON I SAR N M M I A C S SB GL AN I MK O
6 | O AV TO U A ELLISS MA ID A E L I P O E A EL IS AL A ENZA LO A E
7 | OTRE MO L SC ARE TU TI I R O I E A CH AN O
8 | UAND HO AR ATO DE LA MI E I I O CO PIA I R D RE
9 | NVIE O SU IT UNA L TTERA A T H G L I P RE ZER S CU A ENZK A I

Key
b5c753b0_9bf8ea76_ee82_227b9adaa029_eef84a35f9_fd_0b_84_4a_b4_ed_bd_ced8_1c7032
16d3_31c1_6a_df06cb96_bf1f_30_6b_5b
```

flag: flag\_M\_y\_\_\_\_P\_\_\_\_g\_m\_r\_\_

<sup>1</sup> <https://github.com/CameronLonsdale/MTP>

# Crypto 06 - One more Time Please

## Decryptions

```
1 IL CRITTOSISTEMA CHE STO UTILIZZANDO SEMBRA INDISTRUTTIBILE
2 NON LEGGERAI MAI QUESTA SEGRETISSIMA FRASE
3 LA MIA PREZIOSA FLAG: flag{M4ny_71m3_P4D_N1gH7m4r3}
4 I MIEI AMICI CONTINUANO A DIRMICI CHE NON DOVREI UTILIZZARE PIU DI UNA VOLTA LA STESSA
5 SONO SICURO CHE NON CI SARANNO PROBLEMI, I MIEI AMICI SI SBAGLIANO DI CERTO
6 HO AVUTO UNA BELLISSIMA IDEA PER RISOLVERE IL PROBLEMA DEL RISCALDAMENTO GLOBALE
7 POTREMMO LASCIARE TUTTI I FRIGORIFERI APERTI PER QUALCHE ANNO
8 QUANDO HO PARLATO DELLA MIA IDEA AI MIEI AMICI SONO SCOPPIATI A RIDERE...
9 INVIERO SUBITO UNA LETTERA A STEPHEN HAWKING, LUI APPREZZERA SICURAMENTE LA MIA IDEA
```

## Key

```
78b5c753b08f9bf8ea76a8ee822d227b9adaa02903eeef84a35f992fd6b5b0b8548a45f6796841a3453ac594a90d5b4d9ed4b34bdbbced8221c7032
2916d3ca31c1256a12df06c5982d63bf1fdf302c6bb30b0f3a
```

flag: flag{M4ny\_71m3\_P4D\_N1gH7m4r3}

<sup>1</sup> <https://github.com/CameronLonsdale/MTP>



# Challenges

CR\_1.01 - Spin Arovnd

CR\_1.02 - Planet Matrix

CR\_1.03 - Dropped

CR\_1.05 - Once Too Many

CR\_1.09 - TwoFlags

CR\_1.06 - Benchmark